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An in-depth comparison between the internal hardware that runs the premium devices. <http://dgit.in/nov20-61>



The Backbone One

A console-style gaming controller for your iPhone that comes with a companion app. <http://dgit.in/nov20-62>

Oppo Enco W51ANC without breaking the bank

Of late, we are seeing a shift in the audio market where manufacturers are offering premium features in their mid-range true wireless solutions to appeal to the more price-conscious customers. The Oppo Enco W51 is one such mid-ranger that comes with numerous enticing features. While it certainly looks good on paper, let's delve into our full review to find out if it performs well.

Build and comfort

On its surface, the Oppo Enco W51 may look like yet another AirPods Pro clone, however, its unique charging case and the design language of the earbuds set them apart. The stem of the buds is flattened and the touch sensor is placed slightly lower on the stem than the conventional higher placement. Unfortunately, the odd placement led to the buds often not registering taps.

The earbuds feature an oblong shape that is comfortable for most ears, however, smaller ears (like the reviewer's) may feel some fatigue after wearing these buds for a few hours. These buds are also rated IP54 dust and water-resistant.

The charging case of the Oppo Enco W51 is sleek, lightweight and ultra-pocketable. It's shaped like a flat squarish pillow with the Oppo logo smacked on top of the lid and the USB Type-C port at the back alongside an LED indicator light.

Features

The most enticing feature of the Oppo Enco W51 is, no doubt, the Active Noise Cancellation. These earbuds employ a whopping six hybrid noise reduction microphones as well as a dual-core noise reduction chip to achieve a noise reduction depth of up to 35dB, as per the company. The Oppo Enco W51 did a surprisingly good job at cutting out certain ambient sounds, for earbuds. They manage to cancel out a significant



amount of sound in the low frequencies.

The earbuds are powered by Bluetooth v5.0 and come with SBC and AAC codec support, no aptX, unfortunately. You also get touch controls, wireless Qi charging, and wear detection (auto pause/play).

The wear detection is more integral that you initially realise since, for non-Oppo phones that are stuck with the default touch controls, this is the only way to pause or play music. The touch commands are limited to the double taps and triple taps, where a double tap on the right side will take you to the next track, and a double-tap on the left cycles through ANC mode and normal mode. A triple tap on either earbud activates your device's Voice Assistant. Overall, the Oppo Enco W51 are feature-laden but we wish that the ability to customise controls wasn't just limited to Oppo users since the default controls aren't all-encompassing.

Sound quality

The Oppo Enco W51 houses a 7mm dynamic driver and features a V-shaped sonic signature with boosted bass and emphasised treble. The bass response, especially the upper bass region, sounds dynamic and lively. However, the problem arises when you hear tracks with low-bass or sub-bass

response. The bass response here seems exceedingly boomy. The vocals, by themselves, have character and good tonality, however, they seem a bit receded in the grand scheme of things.

The treble is detailed and sparkly for the most part, however, in tracks such as *Hunter* by Bjork, there's no missing the sibilance that overpowers the entire track. Microphone quality on the Oppo Enco W51 is pretty mediocre. While there wasn't an overbearing amount of distortion during calls, the microphone does pick up a fair amount of background sounds.

Battery life

The Oppo Enco W51's battery life is definitely on the lower side when it comes to true wireless earphones.

The earbuds themselves have a fairly measly playtime of 3.5 hours with ANC on and 4 hours with ANC off. In total, the earbuds sport combined battery life (charging case + earbuds) of 20 hours with ANC turned on and 24 hours with ANC turned off. While it's a decent total playtime, the battery life on the buds is below average.



BUILD AND DESIGN.....	73
FEATURES.....	73
PERFORMANCE.....	69
VALUE.....	72

Bottomline

Priced at ₹4,999, the Oppo Enco W51 is an enticing purchase, chock full with premium features at an affordable price. However, a few features such as customisable touch controls are reserved for Oppo phones only, which is disappointing. Nevertheless, at under 5K, the earbuds provide enough value for money to get a recommendation from us.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 55.5g (with case) | IP RATING: IP54 water & dust resistance | DRIVER: Single 7mm dynamic driver | DRIVER SENSITIVITY: 103dB @1kHz | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20Hz-20kHz | CONNECTIVITY: Bluetooth 5.0 | CODECS: AAC, SBC | RANGE: 10 m | BATTERY LIFE: 3.5 hours on a single charge (with ANC), 20 hours with charging case | CHARGING: USB Type C port

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